

wrinkles. For commercial proprietary software, there's a dedicated team of bug fixers. For open source software, you turn your gaze to the community behind the software - and GIMP has a very enthusiastic and dedicated community. With alternative builds and firmware upgrades being posted by users themselves on the GIMP forums, GIMP has the backing of its users, so problems don't remain problems for too long.

In addition to that, the lack of a price tag does not mean that GIMP lacks anything in the features department. It has enough going for it to be a very realistic rival to any of the paid professional software out there.

GIMP's interface is extremely malleable and customisable with several amazing plugins and builds created by the GIMP community itself. The community has come up with several tools that can put Photoshop on edge. The GIMP program comes with access to its own set of tutorials to make using the software much easier. If you want to move out of the amateur zone, GIMP comes with features ranging from filters to layer masks and brushes to elementary animation - courtesy of the GIMP users' community. Oh and of course: It's all free.

Pros and Cons:

There is a good reason why Adobe Photoshop is the leading graphic design program on the industry level. Herein lies the primary difference between GIMP and Photoshop - while GIMP is great at both entry level as well as professional editing, Photoshop is a chore for people on the entry level of the game.

When it comes to the in-built features, both software can handle raster bitmaps perfectly well, but Photoshop does have the added advantage of being able to deal with Vector images as well as RAW files more effortlessly than GIMP. GIMP uses the .xcf file format as opposed to Photoshop's .psd format. Although GIMP is able to open some .psd files, most of the features commonly found in .psd files such as layer styles, filter layers and other features. These features, specifically those related to non-destructive editing or vector graphics are ignored since GIMP does not support them.



Quite neat if you ask us